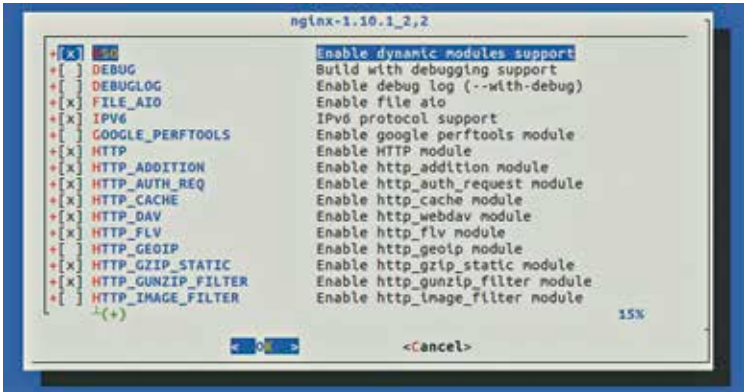


Needless to say, prerequisites for this chapter include basic knowledge of FreeBSD and FreeBSD installed on your system.

That said, let's understand how we can install stuff on FreeBSD.



Third-Party Software in FreeBSD

Installing software: an overview

FreeBSD contains entities known as ports, whose job it is to automate the process of the compilation of an application completely. The files that are a part of a port are code to carry out all tasks from extraction to final installation.

FreeBSD has over 24 thousand compatible third-party applications ported to it. The applications are generally available as packages. Both ports and packages generally have dependencies, meaning that their installation is dependent on the installation of another library. When you give the command for installation, this library will generally be installed before the intended application automatically.

Packages and ports both have certain benefits in FreeBSD. A package will generally be significantly smaller in size than the source code of the application being installed. They also do not require any time for compilation, and installation takes place without any significant intervention from the user. When it comes to ports, the compilation options can be changed by the user. Ports are necessary for software that need to be compiled by the end-user and are not available as packages. They are also a great option if you intend to apply a custom patch to software that is already a part of your system.